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Dual armature single field DC motor/generator

Abstract

A dual armature single field DC motor/generator including at least some of a rotatable shaft maintained relative to a housing; an inner rotor armature secured to the rotatable shaft and including inner rotor armature electromagnets; field poles secured to the housing, each having a field pole electromagnet; interpoles secured to the housing, each having an interpole electromagnet; an inner rotor commutator assembly including an inner rotor commutator and inner rotor brush leads, wherein each inner rotor armature electromagnet is in electrical contact with a segment of the inner rotor commutator; an outer rotor armature secured to the rotatable shaft and including outer rotor armature electromagnets; and an outer rotor commutator assembly including an outer rotor commutator and outer rotor brush leads, wherein each of the outer rotor armature electromagnets in electrical contact with a segment of the outer rotor commutator.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS

(1) None.

STATEMENT REGARDING FEDERALLY SPONSORED RESEARCH OR DEVELOPMENT

(2) Not Applicable.

REFERENCE TO SEQUENCE LISTING, A TABLE, OR A COMPUTER PROGRAM LISTING COMPACT DISC APPENDIX

(3) Not Applicable.

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BACKGROUND OF THE PRESENT DISCLOSURE

1. Field of the Present Disclosure

(5) The present disclosure relates generally to the field of electric motors and generators.

2. Description of Related Art

(6) It is generally known to have Alternating Current (AC) electric motors or AC generators utilizing a single field and multiple armatures. This disclosure uses DC.

(7) Any discussion of documents, acts, materials, devices, articles, or the like, which has been included in the present specification is not to be taken as an admission that any or all of these matters form part of the prior art base or were common general knowledge in the field relevant to the present disclosure as it existed before the priority date of each claim of this application.

BRIEF SUMMARY OF THE PRESENT DISCLOSURE

(8) The present disclosure describes a working prototype for a single field, dual armatures, Direct Current (DC) motor or DC generator (It may be used as either a motor or generator). The following terms are defined in their application to describe this embodiment.

(9) Armatures: Each rotating armature consists of an electromagnet and a commutator. The electromagnet consists of iron core laminations and an electrical circuit, made up of copper wire coils and a commutator, which when energized, magnetizes the iron core. The commutator is the rotating electromagnet's electric power transfer point. It consists of a segmented copper ring which transfers power between the rotating armature and stationary carbon brushes. Leads attached to the stationary brushes allow electrical current to transfer to or from the rotating armature. The commutator segments allow armature current direction to be reversed as the armature coils traverse the stationary north and south field poles permitting rotational torque to continue in the same direction in a motor or production of a DC voltage in a generator.

(10) Shunt Field Poles: Each field pole consists of a stationary electromagnet. Two or more field pole pairs are located diametrically opposite of each other and are mounted in a way that direct the fields magnetic flux to interact with both rotating armatures. They are electrically connected such that each pair creates a north and south pole. Their electric current is in parallel with the armature current to provide better control of the machine.

(11) Interpoles: Each interpole consists of a stationary electromagnet. Two or more interpole pairs are located diametrically opposite of each other and are mounted in a way that direct the fields magnetic flux to interact with the rotating armatures. Their purpose is to ensure that commutation of the armature current occurs in the magnetic neutral plane between field poles, to minimize carbon brush arcing throughout the machines load range. They are electrically connected such that each pair creates a north and south pole. Their electric current is in series with the armature current.

(12) The DC motor/generator in this disclosure provides an inner and outer DC armature mounted on a single shaft supported by one bearing on each end of the shaft. Fixed shunt field poles and interpoles are staggered radially in an air gap between the inner rotor armature and the outer rotor armature. The armatures may be externally connected for single, series, or parallel operation. The dual armature single field Direct Current (DC) motor/generator of the present disclosure may be operated as a DC generator or DC motor. The electromagnetic DC shunt field allows adjustable output voltage control when operated as a DC generator or enhanced adjustable speed control when operated as a DC motor.

(13) By using two armatures, one radially inside the field poles and the other radially external to the field poles, the total magnetic flux linkage between the armatures and field poles is approximately double the flux used by a single armature representing a more efficient use of the field pole.

(14) In certain exemplary, nonlimiting embodiments, The machine is forced air cooled using a shaft mounted cooling fan and a system of ducts and baffles. An optional water-cooled air cooler may be

externally attached.

(15) The separately excited stationary shunt field poles operate at a DC excitation current to produce a strong magnetic field in its aperture and external to the pole.

(16) The reaction torque of the stationary field coil is transmitted by the field pole/interpole support to the housing of the DC motor/generator.

(17) One end of the armature assembly rotatable shaft (Drive End) is generally provided with a high torque capacity coupling to transmit armature circuit mechanical power to or from an external device.

(18) In certain exemplary, nonlimiting embodiments, the dual armature single field DC motor/generator of the present disclosure provides at least some of a housing; a shaft, wherein the rotatable shaft is maintained in an axial position relative to the housing by bearings; an inner rotor armature secured to the rotatable shaft; one or more field pole pairs; one or more interpole pairs, wherein the field poles and the interpoles are each secured to the housing; inner and outer armature brush box assemblies containing stationary brushes to conduct DC current to or from the rotating armatures.

(19) In certain exemplary, nonlimiting embodiments, either rolling element or sleeve bearings are attached or mounted in housing endplates to support the shaft.

(20) In certain exemplary, nonlimiting embodiments, one or more brush access apertures are formed through the housing to allow access from the exterior of the housing to the inner or outer rotor commutator and brush box assemblies.

(21) In certain exemplary, nonlimiting embodiments, each armature, field pole, and interpole windings are wound on separate laminated iron cores.

(22) In certain exemplary, nonlimiting embodiments, the inner and outer rotor armatures are electrically coupled to a connection box on the exterior of the housing.

(23) In certain exemplary, nonlimiting embodiments, the inner rotor armature and the outer rotor armature form substantially concentric circles around the rotatable shaft. The inner rotor armature is located inside the field poles and the interpoles, while the outer rotor armature is located outside the field poles and the interpoles.

(24) In certain exemplary, nonlimiting embodiments, the number of the interpole pairs corresponds to a number of the field pole pairs.

(25) In certain exemplary, nonlimiting embodiments, the inner rotor brush rigging assembly and the outer rotor brush rigging assembly are adjusted independently such that commutation occurs in the neutral plane on each rotor armature.

(26) In certain exemplary, nonlimiting embodiments, the present disclosure separately and optionally provides a dual armature single field DC motor/generator that may be operated as a DC generator or DC motor.

(27) The present disclosure separately and optionally provides a dual armature single field DC motor/generator that operates with only one bearing on each end of the shaft.

(28) The present disclosure separately and optionally provides a dual armature single field DC motor/generator that does not require an external rectifier to convert armature Alternating Current (AC) to Direct Current (DC).

(29) The present disclosure separately and optionally provides a dual armature single field DC motor/generator that, with both armatures connected in series, twice the power of single armature operation is required to rotate the generator and twice the generator output power is realized.

(30) The present disclosure separately and optionally provides a dual armature single field DC motor/generator that uses commutators to reverse current in the armature coils, which allows us to use DC current directly on the armature without the need of slip rings to transfer AC power and external rectifiers to convert the AC to DC power.

(31) The present disclosure separately and optionally provides a dual armature single field DC motor/generator that is easier and less expensive to manufacture and maintain.

(32) These and other aspects, features, and advantages of the present disclosure are described in or are apparent from the following detailed description of the exemplary, non-limiting embodiments of the present disclosure and the accompanying figures. Other aspects and features of embodiments of the present disclosure will become apparent to those of ordinary skill in the art upon reviewing the following description of specific, exemplary embodiments of the present disclosure in concert with the figures.

(33) While features of the present disclosure may be discussed relative to certain embodiments and figures, all embodiments of the present disclosure can include one or more of the features discussed herein. Further, while one or more embodiments may be discussed as having certain advantageous features, one or more of such features may also be used with the various embodiments of the systems, methods, and/or apparatuses discussed herein. In similar fashion, while exemplary embodiments may be discussed below as device, system, or method embodiments, it is to be understood that such exemplary embodiments can be implemented in various devices, systems, and methods of the present disclosure.

(34) Any benefits, advantages, or solutions to problems that are described herein with regard to specific embodiments are not intended to be construed as a critical, required, or essential feature(s) or element(s) of the present disclosure or the claims.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE SEVERAL VIEWS OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) As required, detailed exemplary embodiments of the present disclosure are disclosed herein; however, it is to be understood that the disclosed embodiments are merely exemplary of the present disclosure that may be embodied in various and alternative forms, within the scope of the present disclosure. The figures are not necessarily to scale; some features may be exaggerated or minimized to illustrate details of particular components. Therefore, specific structural and functional details disclosed herein are not to be interpreted as limiting, but merely as a basis for the claims and as a representative basis for teaching one skilled in the art to employ the present disclosure.

(2) The exemplary embodiments of the present disclosure will be described in detail, with reference to the following figures, wherein like reference numerals refer to like parts throughout the several views, and wherein:

(3) FIG. 1 illustrates a perspective view of certain exemplary components of an exemplary embodiment of a dual armature single field DC motor/generator, according to the present disclosure.

(4) FIG. 2 illustrates a side cross-sectional view taken along line 2-2 of FIG. 1 of certain exemplary components of an exemplary embodiment of a dual armature single field DC motor/generator, according to the present disclosure.

(5) FIG. 3 illustrates front cross-sectional view of certain exemplary components of an exemplary embodiment of a dual armature single field DC motor/generator, according to an exemplary embodiment of the present disclosure; and

(6) FIG. 4 illustrates a more detailed view of a portion of an exemplary outer rotor of an exemplary embodiment of a dual armature single field DC motor/generator, according to the present disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF EXEMPLARY EMBODIMENTS OF THE PRESENT DISCLOSURE

(7) For simplicity and clarification, the design factors and operating principles of the dual armature single field DC motor/generator according to the present disclosure are explained with reference to various exemplary embodiments of a dual armature single field DC motor/generator according to

the present disclosure. The basic explanation of the design factors and operating principles of the dual armature single field DC motor/generator is applicable for the understanding, design, and operation of the dual armature single field DC motor/generator of the present disclosure. It should be appreciated that the dual armature single field DC motor/generator can be adapted to many applications where a DC motor/generator can be used.

(8) As used herein, the word “may” is meant to convey a permissive sense (i.e., meaning “having the potential to”), rather than a mandatory sense (i.e., meaning “must”). Unless stated otherwise, terms such as “first” and “second”, “right” and “left”, “top” and “bottom”, “upper” and “lower”, and “horizontal” and “vertical” are used to arbitrarily distinguish between the exemplary embodiments and/or elements such terms describe. Thus, these terms are not necessarily intended to indicate temporal or other prioritization of such exemplary embodiments and/or elements.

(9) As used herein, and unless the context dictates otherwise, the term “coupled” is intended to include both direct coupling (in which two elements that are coupled to each other contact each other) and indirect coupling (in which at least one additional element is located between the two elements). The term coupled, as used herein, is defined as connected, although not necessarily directly, and not necessarily mechanically. The terms “a” and “an” are defined as one or more unless stated otherwise.

(10) Throughout this application, the terms “comprise” (and any form of comprise, such as “comprises” and “comprising”), “have” (and any form of have, such as “has” and “having”), “include”, (and any form of include, such as “includes” and “including”) and “contain” (and any form of contain, such as “contains” and “containing”) are used as open-ended linking verbs. It will be understood that these terms are meant to imply the inclusion of a stated element, integer, step, or group of elements, integers, or steps, but not the exclusion of any other element, integer, step, or group of elements, integers, or steps. As a result, a system, method, or apparatus that “comprises”, “has”, “includes”, or “contains” one or more elements possesses those one or more elements but is not limited to possessing only those one or more elements. Similarly, a method or process that “comprises”, “has”, “includes” or “contains” one or more operations possesses those one or more operations but is not limited to possessing only those one or more operations.

(11) It should also be appreciated that, for simplicity and clarification, certain embodiments of the present disclosure may be described using terms such as “front”, “back”, “rear”, “right”, “left”, “upper”, “lower”, “outer”, and/or “inner”. However, it should be understood that these terms are merely used to aid in understanding of the present disclosure are not to be construed as limiting the systems, methods, devices, and/or apparatuses of the present disclosure. Additionally, it should be appreciated that, unless otherwise stated, the design factors and operating principles of the presently disclosed dual armature single field DC motor/generator may optionally be used in a “mirror image” assembly, wherein elements shown and/or described as being included in or on a drive end portion may optionally be included in or on a non-drive end portion. Alternatively, certain of the elements that are shown and/or described as being included in or on a back portion may optionally be included in or on a front portion, or vice versa.

(12) It should also be appreciated that the terms “dual armature single field DC motor/generator”, “dual armature”, “single field”, “DC motor”, and “generator” are used for basic explanation and understanding of the operation of the systems, methods, and apparatuses of the present disclosure. Therefore, the terms “dual armature single field DC motor/generator”, “dual armature”, “single field”, “DC motor”, and “generator” are not to be construed as limiting the systems, methods, and apparatuses of the present disclosure.

(13) Furthermore, it should be appreciated that, for simplicity and clarification, the embodiments of the present disclosure will be shown and/or described with reference to a certain number of leads being included on various portions of the dual armature single field DC motor/generator. However, it should be appreciated that the inclusion and/or specific placement of any number of leads is not essential to the dual armature single field DC motor/generator of the present disclosure.

(14) Turning now to the appended drawing figures, FIGS. **1-4** illustrate certain elements and/or aspects of an exemplary embodiment of a dual armature single field DC motor/generator, according to the present disclosure. As shown in FIGS. **1, 2, and 3** the DC motor/generator **100** comprises at least some of a housing **102**, a rolling element bearing **103** with bearing retainers **104** or a bushing bearing **105** having a bushing bearing housing **106**, a rotatable shaft **110**, an outer rotor brush rigging assembly **120**, outer rotor brush leads **125**, one or more outer rotor brush apertures **127**, an inner rotor brush rigging assembly **130**, inner rotor brush leads **135**, one or more inner rotor brush apertures **137**, an outer rotor commutator **140**, an inner rotor commutator **150**, an outer rotor armature core **160** having an outer rotor armature winding **165**, an inner rotor armature core **170** having an inner rotor armature winding **175**, an inner rotor **180**, a field pole cores **190** having a field pole windings **193**, and an interpole cores **195** having an interpole winding **197**.

(15) In certain exemplary embodiments, brush access apertures **127** are formed through portions of the housing **102** to allow access from the exterior of the housing **102** to the outer rotor brush rigging assembly **120** and/or the inner rotor brush rigging assembly **130**.

(16) As illustrated, the DC motor/generator **100** comprises a rotatable shaft **110**, which is maintained in a fixed, freely rotatable, axial position by bearing retainers **104** and rolling element bearings **103**. In various exemplary embodiments, the shaft may be supported by babbit sleeve bearing assemblies **105** and **106** with or without thrust features. Rolling element bearings **103** may be ball or roller bearings, or any other suitable means capable of maintaining the rotatable shaft **110** in a fixed axial position which allows the rotatable shaft **110** to rotate in a conventional manner. The rolling element bearings **103** may optionally be grease or oil lubricated. The babbit sleeve bearings **105** will be oil lubricated.

(17) The bearing retainers **104** or rolling element bearings **103** are attached or coupled to the housing endplates **107** and **108**, such that the rotatable shaft **110** is maintained in an appropriate axial position relative to the housing **102** and is able to rotate relative to the housing **102**.

(18) In certain exemplary embodiments, a cooling fan **109** is attached or coupled to the rotatable shaft **110** and an air baffle **111** may be attached to the field pole assembly **190** to provide forced air cooling within at least a portion of the housing **102**.

(19) The outer rotor armature and the inner rotor armature are secured to the rotatable shaft **110**. The outer rotor armature is secured to the rotatable shaft **110**, via an outer rotor support **168**. The field poles **190** and the interpoles **195** are secured to the housing endplate **107**, via a field pole/interpole support **198**.

(20) The inner rotor armature and the outer rotor armature form substantially concentric circles around the rotatable shaft and are each secured to the rotatable shaft. The inner rotor armature is located inside the field poles and the interpoles, while the outer rotor armature is located outside the field poles and the interpoles.

(21) All armature, interpole, and field pole cores are comprised of a plurality of insulated iron laminations.

(22) Each of the inner rotor armature and the outer rotor armature comprises a series of coils, or toroidal windings, wound around each inner rotor core and each outer rotor core, respectively.

(23) Each toroidal winding of the outer rotor armature **165** is in electrical contact with an appropriate section or segment of the outer rotor commutator **140**. In various exemplary embodiments, the outer rotor brush rigging assembly **120** is electrically coupled to the appropriate, electrically conductive sections or segments of the outer rotor commutator **140** such that electrical current may be provided to the electrically conductive sections or segments of the outer rotor commutator **140**.

(24) The outer rotor brush rigging assembly **120** is electrically coupled to an appropriate current or power source by brush leads **125**.

(25) Similarly, each toroidal winding of the inner rotor armature **175** is in electrical contact with an appropriate section or segment of the inner rotor commutator **150**, via the inner rotor commutator

150. In various exemplary embodiments, the inner rotor brush rigging assembly **130** is electrically coupled to the appropriate, electrically conductive sections or segments of the inner rotor commutator **150** such that electrical current may be provided to the electrically conductive sections or segments of the inner rotor commutator **150**.

(26) The inner rotor brush rigging assembly **130** is electrically coupled to an appropriate current or power source by brush leads **135**.

(27) The segments of the outer rotor commutator **140** are in electrical contact with the outer rotor brush rigging assembly **120** using presently known methods, which are understood and apparent to those skilled in the art. In various exemplary embodiments, the outer rotor brush rigging assembly **120** comprises metal or carbon, which makes electrical contact with the section(s) or segment(s) of the outer rotor commutator **140**.

(28) In this manner, each electrically conductive segment of the outer rotor commutator **140** may be in sequential electrical contact with an appropriate toroidal winding, via a corresponding brush lead **125**.

(29) Thus, as the rotatable shaft **110** is rotated, appropriate segments of the outer rotor commutator **140** are in sequential electrical contact with the outer rotor brush rigging assembly **120** and an appropriate current is provided to the toroidal windings of the outer rotor armature windings **165**.

(30) Similarly, as the rotatable shaft **110** is rotated, appropriate segments of the inner rotor commutator **150** are in sequential electrical contact with the inner rotor brush rigging assembly **130** and an appropriate current may be selectively provided to the toroidal windings of the inner rotor armature winding **175**. Thus,

(31) However, it should be appreciated that in various exemplary embodiments, the inner rotor commutator **150** and the outer rotor commutator **140** are identical to one another and are phased independently so that each of the inner rotor commutator **150** and the outer rotor commutator **140** switches at its respective neutral plane. In various exemplary, nonlimiting embodiments, each of the inner rotor commutator **150** and the outer rotor commutator **140** has 99 bars and each rotor has 33 slots, each slot has 6 wires, 3 each from 2 overlapping coils wound in a wave pattern, and each commutator has 4 brushes.

(32) The field poles **190** and the interpoles **195** are positioned at equally spaced apart locations from one another, forming a substantially concentric circle between the inner rotor armature **170** and the outer rotor armature **160**. Each field pole **190** is positioned between two interpoles **195** and each interpoles **195** is positioned between two field poles **190**. The number of field poles **190** corresponds to the number of interpoles **195**.

(33) Each field pole winding **193** is in electrical contact with an appropriate shunt field power source, via a respective one or more field pole leads **194**. Similarly, each interpole winding **197** is in electrical contact with an appropriate armature current power source, via a respective one or more interpole leads **196**.

(34) Thus, an appropriate current may be selectively provided to the field pole windings **193** interpole windings **197**.

(35) It should be appreciated that, for simplicity and clarification, the embodiments of this DC motor/generator **100** are shown and/or described with reference to the DC motor/generator **100** having four field poles **190** and four interpoles **195**. However, the number of field poles **190** and interpoles **195** of the DC motor/generator **100** is intended to be illustrative, not limiting. Thus, it should be understood that the number of field poles **190** and interpoles **195** of the DC motor/generator **100** may be varied and more or less than four field poles **190** and four interpoles **195** may be used, depending on, for example, the desired size of the DC motor/generator **100** or the specific application DC motor/generator **100** is to be used in.

(36) As illustrated most clearly in FIG. 3, in certain exemplary, nonlimiting embodiments, the pole face of the inner rotor armature **170** spans 5 or 6 slots ($\Theta 1$ of approximately 61°) on the inner rotor armature **170** and only 3 slots ($\Theta 2$ of approximately 29°) on the outer rotor armature **160**. It should

be appreciated that this is exemplary and not limiting. Thus, the pole face of the inner rotor armature **170** may span any desired number of slots on the inner rotor armature **170** and slots on the outer rotor armature **160**. In certain exemplary embodiments, the inner rotor armature **170** and the outer rotor armature **160** span the same angle to reduce commutator sparking and increased torque or, if used as a generator, induced voltage.

(37) It should be appreciated that appropriate apertures are formed through one or more portions of the housing **102** so as to provide access to an inner region or portion of the of the DC motor/generator **100** to permit the passage of the various electrical leads.

(38) A more detailed explanation of the instructions regarding how to provide current and/or power to the DC motor/generator **100** and/or receive generated current and/or power from the DC motor/generator **100** is not provided herein because it is believed that the level of description provided herein is sufficient to enable one of ordinary skill in the art to understand and practice the systems, methods, and apparatuses, as described.

(39) In certain exemplary, nonlimiting embodiments, the DC motor/generator **100** can be used as a diesel driven DC generator suitable for generating marine propulsion power.

(40) In certain exemplary, nonlimiting embodiments, the DC motor/generator **100** can be used as a wind driven DC generator.

(41) In certain exemplary, nonlimiting embodiments, the DC motor/generator **100** can be used as a DC motor for marine or land vehicle propulsion and other high reliability requirements.

(42) In certain exemplary, nonlimiting embodiments, the DC motor/generator **100** permits quiet, reliable, variable speed, reversible, high torque, high power operation.

(43) In certain exemplary, nonlimiting embodiments, the two rotating, wave wound, outer rotor armature **160** and inner rotor armature **170** are located with one armature adjacent to each pole of a single field. Flux linkage is provided by the metal encased DC motor/generator **100**.

(44) In certain exemplary, nonlimiting embodiments, the fixed, wound, shunt field poles **190** permit output voltage control when used as a DC generator.

(45) In certain exemplary, nonlimiting embodiments, the fixed, wound, shunt field poles **190** permit speed control when used as a DC motor/generator.

(46) In certain exemplary, nonlimiting embodiments, the inner rotor armature and outer rotor armature assemblies have their own independent commutators, and brush rigging assemblies for the direct transfer of DC armature current.

(47) In certain exemplary, nonlimiting embodiments, external switchgear could be used to, locally or remotely, reverse direction of a DC motor/generator.

(48) In certain exemplary, nonlimiting embodiments, because the inner rotor armature **170** and the outer rotor armature **160** operate independently of each other, external switchgear could be used to, locally or remotely, to isolate one of the armatures. This allows continued operation at 50% power in the event of one faulty armature.

(49) Two concentric rotors on one rotatable shaft **110** allows the use of two instead of four bearings supporting the inner rotor armature **170** and the outer rotor armature **160**. Minimizing the number of bearings in a two-armature motor/generator reduces the possibility of having a bearing failure.

(50) In various exemplary, nonlimiting embodiments, the armature and field coil field pole electromagnet **193** and interpole electromagnet **197** use copper conductor materials. There are no permanent magnets. Exotic materials containing rare earth elements are not required for this DC motor/generator **100**.

(51) In various exemplary, nonlimiting embodiments, the armature and field coils are Vacuum Pressure Impregnated with high reliability insulating epoxy.

(52) For certain DC motor/generators **100**, internal forced air flow can be ducted to an external air cooler for the efficient removal of heat generated by inherent electrical machine power losses.

(53) While the present disclosure has been described in conjunction with the exemplary embodiments outlined above, the foregoing description of exemplary embodiments of the present

disclosure, as set forth above, are intended to be illustrative, not limiting and the fundamental disclosed systems, methods, and/or apparatuses should not be considered to be necessarily so constrained. It is evident that the present disclosure is not limited to the particular variation set forth and many alternatives, adaptations modifications, and/or variations will be apparent to those skilled in the art.

(54) Furthermore, where a range of values is provided, it is understood that every intervening value, between the upper and lower limit of that range and any other stated or intervening value in that stated range is encompassed within the present disclosure. The upper and lower limits of these smaller ranges may independently be included in the smaller ranges and is also encompassed within the present disclosure, subject to any specifically excluded limit in the stated range. Where the stated range includes one or both of the limits, ranges excluding either or both of those included limits are also included in the present disclosure.

(55) It is to be understood that the phraseology of terminology employed herein is for the purpose of description and not of limitation. Unless defined otherwise, all technical and scientific terms used herein have the same meaning as commonly understood by one of ordinary skill in the art to which the present disclosure belongs.

(56) In addition, it is contemplated that any optional feature of the inventive variations described herein may be set forth and claimed independently, or in combination with any one or more of the features described herein.

(57) Accordingly, the foregoing description of exemplary embodiments will reveal the general nature of the present disclosure, such that others may, by applying current knowledge, change, vary, modify, and/or adapt these exemplary, non-limiting embodiments for various applications without departing from the spirit and scope of the present disclosure and elements or methods similar or equivalent to those described herein can be used in practicing the present disclosure. Any and all such changes, variations, modifications, and/or adaptations should and are intended to be comprehended within the meaning and range of equivalents of the disclosed exemplary embodiments and may be substituted without departing from the true spirit and scope of the present disclosure.

(58) Also, it is noted that as used herein and in the appended claims, the singular forms “a”, “and”, “said”, and “the” include plural referents unless the context clearly dictates otherwise. Conversely, it is contemplated that the claims may be so-drafted to require singular elements or exclude any optional element indicated to be so here in the text or drawings. This statement is intended to serve as antecedent basis for use of such exclusive terminology as “solely”, “only”, and the like in connection with the recitation of claim elements or the use of a “negative” claim limitation(s).

Claims

1. A dual armature single field Direct Current (DC) motor/generator, comprising: a housing; a rotatable shaft, wherein said rotatable shaft is maintained in a rotatable, axial position relative to said housing; an inner rotor armature secured to said rotatable shaft, wherein said inner rotor armature includes one or more inner rotor armature electromagnets; one or more field poles, each of said one or more field poles having a field pole electromagnet; one or more interpoles, each of said one or more interpoles having an interpole electromagnet, wherein said field poles and said interpoles are each secured to said housing; an inner rotor commutator assembly including an inner rotor commutator and one or more inner rotor brush leads, wherein each of said inner rotor armature electromagnets is in electrical contact with an appropriate segment of said inner rotor commutator, via said inner rotor commutator assembly, such that an electrical current may be selectively provided to said electrically conductive segments of said inner rotor commutator; an outer rotor armature secured to said rotatable shaft, wherein said outer rotor armature includes one or more outer rotor armature electromagnets; and an outer rotor commutator assembly including an

outer rotor commutator and one or more outer rotor brush leads, wherein each of said outer rotor armature electromagnets is in electrical contact with an appropriate segment of said outer rotor commutator, via said outer rotor commutator assembly, such that an electrical current may be selectively provided to said electrically conductive segments of said outer rotor commutator.

2. The Direct Current (DC) motor/generator of claim 1, wherein said bearing retainers or rolling element bearings are attached or coupled to housing endplates of said housing.

3. The Direct Current (DC) motor/generator of claim 1, wherein one or more brush access apertures are formed through said housing to allow access from said exterior of said housing to said outer rotor commutator assembly and/or said inner rotor commutator assembly.

4. The Direct Current (DC) motor/generator of claim 1, wherein said dual armature single field Direct Current (DC) motor/generator is used as a diesel driven Direct Current (DC) generator.

5. The Direct Current (DC) motor/generator of claim 1, said dual armature single field Direct Current (DC) motor/generator is used as a wind driven Direct Current (DC) generator.

6. The Direct Current (DC) motor/generator of claim 1, wherein said field pole electromagnet and said interpole electromagnets comprise copper conductor materials.

7. The Direct Current (DC) motor/generator of claim 1, wherein each of said inner rotor armature electromagnets comprises a series of coils or toroidal windings, wound around each of said inner rotor armatures.

8. The Direct Current (DC) motor/generator of claim 1, wherein each of said outer rotor armature electromagnets comprises a series of coils or toroidal windings, wound around each of said outer rotor armatures.

9. The Direct Current (DC) motor/generator of claim 1, wherein said outer rotor commutator assembly is electrically coupled to an appropriate current or power source, via one or more brush leads.

10. The Direct Current (DC) motor/generator of claim 1, wherein said inner rotor commutator assembly is electrically coupled to an appropriate current or power source, via one or more brush leads.

11. The Direct Current (DC) motor/generator of claim 1, wherein said inner rotor armature, said outer rotor armature, and said field poles are vacuum pressure impregnated with high reliability insulating epoxy.

12. The Direct Current (DC) motor/generator of claim 1, wherein said inner rotor armature is located inside said field poles and said interpoles, while said outer rotor armature is located outside said field poles and said interpoles.

13. The Direct Current (DC) motor/generator of claim 1, wherein each electrically conductive segment of said outer rotor commutator may be in sequential electrical contact with an appropriate portion of said outer rotor armature electromagnets, via a corresponding brush lead, such that as said rotatable shaft is rotated, appropriate segments of said outer rotor commutator are in sequential electrical contact with said outer rotor commutator assembly and an appropriate current is provided to said appropriate portion of said outer rotor armature electromagnets.

14. The Direct Current (DC) motor/generator of claim 1, wherein each electrically conductive segment of said inner rotor commutator may be in sequential electrical contact with an appropriate portion of said inner rotor armature electromagnets, via a corresponding brush lead, such that as said rotatable shaft is rotated, appropriate segments of said inner rotor commutator are in sequential electrical contact with said inner rotor commutator assembly and an appropriate current may be selectively provided to said appropriate portion of said inner rotor armature electromagnets.

15. The Direct Current (DC) motor/generator of claim 1, wherein a number of said field poles corresponds to a number of said interpoles.

16. The Direct Current (DC) motor/generator of claim 1, wherein an electromagnetic Direct Current (DC) shunt field provides adjustable output voltage control if said dual armature single field Direct Current (DC) motor/generator is operated as a Direct Current (DC) generator.

17. The Direct Current (DC) motor/generator of claim 1, wherein an electromagnetic Direct Current (DC) shunt field provides enhanced adjustable speed control if said dual armature single field Direct Current (DC) motor/generator is operated as a Direct Current (DC) motor.

18. The Direct Current (DC) motor/generator of claim 1, wherein said inner rotor commutator and said outer rotor commutator are phased independently such that each of said inner rotor commutator and said outer rotor commutator switches at a respective neutral plane.

19. A dual armature single field Direct Current (DC) motor/generator, comprising: a rotatable shaft maintained in a rotatable, axial position relative to a housing; an inner rotor armature secured to said rotatable shaft, wherein said inner rotor armature includes one or more inner rotor armature electromagnets; one or more field poles, each of said one or more field poles having a field pole electromagnet; one or more interpoles, each of said one or more interpoles having an interpole electromagnet, wherein said field poles and said interpoles are each secured to said housing; an inner rotor commutator assembly including an inner rotor commutator and one or more inner rotor brush leads, wherein each of said inner rotor armature electromagnets is in electrical contact with an appropriate segment of said inner rotor commutator, via said inner rotor commutator assembly, such that an electrical current may be selectively provided to said electrically conductive segments of said inner rotor commutator; an outer rotor armature secured to said rotatable shaft, wherein said outer rotor armature includes one or more outer rotor armature electromagnets; and an outer rotor commutator assembly including an outer rotor commutator and one or more outer rotor brush leads, wherein each of said outer rotor armature electromagnets is in electrical contact with an appropriate segment of said outer rotor commutator, via said outer rotor commutator assembly, such that an electrical current may be selectively provided to said electrically conductive segments of said outer rotor commutator; wherein if an appropriate amount of an electrical current is selectively provided to said field pole electromagnet and said interpole electromagnet of said field poles and said interpoles, magnetic flux lines extend from said field poles and said interpoles to affect said inner rotor armature electromagnet of said inner rotor armature to create a first magnetic circuit between said field poles and said interpoles and said inner rotor armature; wherein if an appropriate amount of an electrical current is selectively provided to said field poles and said interpoles, magnetic flux lines extend from said field poles and said interpoles to affect said outer rotor armature electromagnet to create a second magnetic circuit between said field poles and said interpoles and said outer rotor armature; wherein if an appropriate amount of an electrical current is selectively provided to said outer rotor armature electromagnet, magnetic flux lines extend from said outer rotor armature to affect said field pole electromagnet and said interpole electromagnet of said field poles and said interpoles to create a third magnetic circuit between said outer rotor armature and said field poles and said interpoles; and wherein if an appropriate amount of an electrical current is selectively provided to said inner rotor armature electromagnet, magnetic flux lines extend from said inner rotor armature to affect said field pole electromagnet and said interpole electromagnet of said field poles and said interpoles to create a fourth magnetic circuit between said inner rotor armature and said field poles and said interpoles.

20. A dual armature single field Direct Current (DC) motor/generator, comprising: a rotatable shaft maintained in a rotatable, axial position relative to a housing; an inner rotor armature secured to said rotatable shaft, wherein said inner rotor armature includes one or more inner rotor armature electromagnets; one or more field poles, each of said one or more field poles having a field pole electromagnet; one or more interpoles, each of said one or more interpoles having an interpole electromagnet, wherein said field poles and said interpoles are each secured to said housing; an inner rotor commutator assembly including an inner rotor commutator and one or more inner rotor brush leads, wherein each of said inner rotor armature electromagnets is in electrical contact with an appropriate segment of said inner rotor commutator, via said inner rotor commutator assembly, such that an electrical current may be selectively provided to said electrically conductive segments of said inner rotor commutator; an outer rotor armature secured to said rotatable shaft, wherein said

outer rotor armature includes one or more outer rotor armature electromagnets; and an outer rotor commutator assembly including an outer rotor commutator and one or more outer rotor brush leads, wherein each of said outer rotor armature electromagnets is in electrical contact with an appropriate segment of said outer rotor commutator, via said outer rotor commutator assembly, such that an electrical current may be selectively provided to said electrically conductive segments of said outer rotor commutator; wherein if an appropriate amount of an electrical current is selectively provided to said field pole electromagnet and said interpole electromagnet of said field poles and said interpoles, magnetic flux lines extend from said field poles and said interpoles to affect said inner rotor armature electromagnet of said inner rotor armature; wherein if an appropriate amount of an electrical current is selectively provided to said field poles and said interpoles, magnetic flux lines extend from said field poles and said interpoles to affect said outer rotor armature electromagnet; wherein if an appropriate amount of an electrical current is selectively provided to said outer rotor armature electromagnet, magnetic flux lines extend from said outer rotor armature to affect said field pole electromagnet and said interpole electromagnet of said field poles and said interpoles; and wherein if an appropriate amount of an electrical current is selectively provided to said inner rotor armature electromagnet, magnetic flux lines extend from said inner rotor armature to affect said field pole electromagnet and said interpole electromagnet of said field poles and said interpoles.
